

9:00 A.M.

Calendar Line # 1
Case Name Vivienne Vlaskovits vs Szilard Vlaskovits
Case No. 24CV438915
Demurrer Defendant filed a demurrer on August 8, 2025 that was accompanied by a proof of service indicating mail service on the same day. Defendant filed an amended notice of demurrer on April 14, 2026 accompanied by a proof of service indicating mail service on the same day. No opposition papers were filed. Per Code of Civil Procedure section 1005(b) opposition papers were due on May 1, 2026. A failure to oppose a motion may be deemed a consent to the granting of the motion. California Rule of Court Rule 8.54c. Failure to oppose a motion leads to the presumption that the plaintiff has no meritorious arguments. (<i>Laguna Auto Body v. Farmers Ins. Exchange</i> (1991) 231 Cal.App.3d 481, 489). Pursuant to Code of Civil Procedure section 430.10, a party may demur to a complaint on the grounds that it “does not state facts sufficient to constitute a cause of action.” (Code Civ. Proc., § 430.10, subd. (e)). A demurrer tests whether the complaint states a cause of action. (<i>Hahn v. Mirda</i> (2007) 147 Cal.App.4th 740, 747 (<i>Hahn</i>)). When considering demurrers, courts accept all well pleaded facts as true. (<i>Fox v. JAMDAT Mobile, Inc.</i> (2010) 185 Cal.App.4th 1068, 1078). In ruling on a demurrer, the Court treats it “as admitting all material facts properly pleaded, but not contentions, deductions or conclusions of fact or law.” (<i>Piccinini v. Cal. Emergency Management Agency</i> (2014) 226 Cal.App.4th 685, 688, citing <i>Blank v. Kirwan</i> (1985) 39 Cal.3d 311, 318 (<i>Blank</i>)). When considering demurrers, courts read the allegations liberally and in context. In a demurrer proceeding, the defects must be apparent on the face of the pleading or via proper judicial notice. (<i>Donabedian v. Mercury Ins. Co.</i> (2004) 116 Cal.App.4th 968, 994.) “A demurrer tests the pleading alone, and not the evidence or facts alleged.” (<i>E-Fab, Inc. v. Accountants, Inc. Servs.</i> (2007) 153 Cal.App.4th 1308, 1315.) As such, the court assumes the truth of the complaint’s properly pleaded or implied factual allegations. (<i>Id.</i>). Moving party meets its burden. The demurrer is SUSTAINED without leave to amend. Moving party to prepare the formal Order.

Calendar Line # 5
Case Name Immigrant Rights Defense Council, LLC et al vs Shamsheer Brar
Case No. 25CV457348
Motion to Compel Request for Production of Documents & Sanctions On July 18, 2025, the plaintiff, Immigration Rights Defense Council (“Plaintiff”) filed a motion to compel response to request for production of document (“RPD”), set one and sanctions against Defendant Shamsheer Brar. The motion was accompanied by a proof of service via mail delivery on that same day. No opposition papers were filed. Per Code of Civil Procedure section 1005(b) opposition papers were due on May 1, 2026. ¹ A failure to oppose a motion may be deemed a consent to the granting of the motion. California Rule of Court Rule 8.54c. Failure to oppose a motion leads to the presumption that the plaintiff has no meritorious arguments. (<i>Laguna Auto Body v. Farmers Ins. Exchange</i> (1991) 231 Cal.App.3d 481, 489). Moving party meets its burden of proof. //

¹ The Court notes that this is the second discovery motion that was unopposed in this matter. On May 5, 2026, the court heard the plaintiff’s motion to deem request for admissions admitted and sanctions. The defendant did not oppose the motion.

I. BACKGROUND

The Court has carefully reviewed Plaintiff's moving papers including, notice of motion, memorandum of points and authorities, Declaration of Sebastian M. Medvei and attached Exhibit 1, and proof of service, (totaling 13 pages); and the pleadings.

II. LEGAL STANDARD

Pursuant to Code of Civil Procedure section 2017.010:

“Unless otherwise limited by order of the court in accordance with this title, any party may obtain discovery regarding any matter, not privileged, that is relevant to the subject matter involved in the pending action or to the determination of any motion made in that action, if the matter either is itself admissible in evidence or appears reasonably calculated to lead to the discovery of admissible evidence.”

For discovery purposes, information is regarded as relevant “if it might reasonably assist a party in evaluating the case, preparing for trial, or facilitating settlement thereof.” (*City of Los Angeles v. Superior Court* (2017) 9 Cal.App.5th 272, 288) .Where a party objects or responds inadequately to discovery requests, a motion lies to compel further responses, and that party has the burden to justify the objections or inadequate responses. (*Fairmont Ins. Co. v. Superior Court* (2000) 22 Cal.4th 245, 255; Code Civ. Proc., § 2031.310, subd. (a) [motion to compel further responses lies “[o]n receipt of a response to a demand for inspection”]). “A trial court’s determination of a motion to compel discovery is reviewed for abuse of discretion. However, when the facts asserted in support of and in opposition to the motion are in conflict, the trial court’s factual findings will be upheld if they are supported by substantial evidence.” (*Costco Wholesale Corp. v. Superior Court* (2009) 47 Cal.4th 725, 733). “The purpose of the discovery rules is to enhance the truth-seeking function of the litigation process and eliminate trial strategies that focus on gamesmanship and surprise. In other words, the discovery process is designed to make a trial less a game of blindman’s bluff and more a fair contest with the basic issues and facts disclosed to the fullest practicable extent.” (*Juarez v. Boy Scouts of Am., Inc.* (2000) 81 Cal.App.4th 377, 389).

A. Procedural Requirements

(1) Timeliness

Code of Civil Procedure section 2030.300, subdivision (c), provides that notice of a motion to compel further responses must be given within 45 days following the service of the verified response, or any supplemental verified response, or by a later date agreed-upon in writing, failing which the propounding party waives any right to compel a further response to the interrogatories. (Code Civ. Proc., § 2030.300, subd. (c); but see *Golf & Tennis Pro Shop, Inc. v. Superior Court* (2022) 84 Cal.App.5th 127, 134-136 [suggesting that the 45-day deadline does not apply to (i.e., it does not begin to run with service of) objections-only responses; it only applies to responses that are required to be verified].)

The 45-day deadline “is ‘jurisdictional’ in the sense that it renders the court without authority to rule on motions to compel other than to deny them.” (*Sexton v. Superior Court* (1997) 58 Cal.App.4th 1403, 1410).

“Any period of notice, or any right or duty to do any act or make any response within any period or on a date certain after the service of the document, which time period or date is prescribed by statute or rule of court, shall be extended after service by electronic means by two court days[.]” (Code Civ. Proc., § 1010.6, subd. (a)(3)(B)).

(2) Meet-and-Confer

“A motion under subdivision (a) shall be accompanied by a meet and confer declaration under Section 2016.040.” (Code Civ. Proc., § 2030.300, subd. (b)(1).) “A meet and confer declaration in support of a motion shall state facts showing a reasonable and good faith attempt at an informal resolution of each issue presented by the motion.” (Code Civ. Proc., § 2016.040).

(3) Separate Statement

California Rules of Court, rule 3.1345 requires that any motion involving the content of discovery contain a separate statement with the text of each request, the response, and a statement of factual and legal reasons for why an order compelling further responses is warranted.

B. Motion to Compel Further Responses to Request for Production of Documents

Code of Civil Procedure section 2031.310(b)(1) sets forth that a motion to compel further responses to a demand for inspection or production of documents may be brought based on: (1) incomplete statements of compliance; (2) inadequate, evasive, or incomplete claims of inability to comply; or (3) unmerited or overly generalized objections. A motion to compel further production must set forth specific facts showing good cause justifying the discovery sought by the inspection demand. (Code Civ. Proc., § 2031.310(b)(1)). In *Digital Music News LLC v Superior Court* (2014) 226 Cal.App.4th 216 at 224, the Court defined “good cause” as a showing that there “a disputed fact that is of consequence in the action and the discovery sought will tend in reason to prove or disprove that fact or lead to other evidence that will tend to prove or disprove the fact.” If the moving party has shown good cause for the requests for production, the burden is on the objecting party to justify the objections. (*Kirkland v. Sup.Ct* (2002) 95 Cal. App.4th 92, 98).

III. ANALYSIS

Plaintiff served Defendant Brar with RPD, Set One, that contained seven (7) RPD on February 13, 2025 that was accompanied by a proof of service indicating mail service (Exhibit 1 to the Declaration of Medvei). Defendant’s verified responses to Plaintiff’s RPD was due on March 20, 2025. (Plaintiff’s motion, at p. 4). Defendant did not serve any responses and pursued this motion to compel responses to RPD, set one, on July 18, 2025 (Declaration of Medvei, at p. 6).

Here, the defendant failed to produce verified responses to discovery that were due over a year ago on March 20, 2025. The court was not provided with any information that the defendant sought an extension or substantially complied with the outstanding discovery prior to this hearing. Per Code of Civil Procedure section 1005(b) opposition papers were due on May 1, 2026. No opposition papers were filed. A failure to oppose a motion may be deemed a consent to the granting of the motion. California Rule of Court Rule 8.54c. Failure to oppose a motion leads to the presumption that the plaintiff has no meritorious arguments. (*Laguna Auto Body v. Farmers Ins. Exchange* (1991) 231 Cal.App.3d 481, 489). Moving party meets its burden of proof.

IV. SANCTIONS

Pursuant to Code of Civil Procedure section 2030.290 provides: “(c) The court shall impose a monetary sanction under Chapter 7 (commencing with Section 2023.010) against any party, person, or attorney who unsuccessfully makes or opposes a motion to compel a response to interrogatories, unless it finds that the one subject to the sanction acted with substantial justification or that other circumstances make the imposition of the sanction unjust. If a party then fails to obey an order compelling answers, the court may make those orders that are just, including the imposition of an issue sanction, an evidence sanction, or a terminating sanction under Chapter 7 (commencing with Section 2023.010). In lieu of or in addition to that sanction, the court may impose a monetary sanction under Chapter 7 (commencing with Section 2023.010).”

Here, Plaintiff's counsel seeks \$2,250.00 for attorney's fees based three hours of work in drafting the motion, researching, and preparing a reply brief, and appearing for the hearing at an hourly rate of \$750.00. The plaintiff also seeks \$60.00 in filing fees.

The request for sanctions is GRANTED in part and DENIED in part in regard to the total amount requested. Considering the relatively straightforward nature of the motion, no opposition brief being timely filed, no reply brief, the Court awards sanctions against the defendant in the amount of \$750.00, calculated based on 1.5 hours including one hour to file the present motion and half an hour to attend the hearing at the rate of \$500.00 per hour. The Court also grants the \$60.00 requested for filing fees. The total amount of sanctions award against the Defendant is \$810.00.

V. CONCLUSION

Based on the foregoing, Plaintiff's unopposed motion to deem RPD, set one is GRANTED.

Plaintiff's request for sanctions is GRANTED in part and DENIED in part as to the total requested amount. Defendant is ORDERED to pay the Plaintiff \$810.00 in sanctions within thirty (30) days of this Order.

Moving party to prepare the formal Order.

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